

# Purely functional distributed programming

for collaborative applications.



@aidylns



@parenthetical

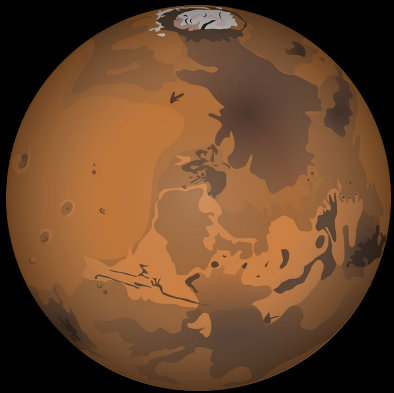
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Work supported by  Protocol  
Labs

 FACULDADE DE  
CIÊNCIAS E TECNOLOGIA  
UNIVERSIDADE NOVA DE LISBOA

 NOVALINCS



*Why is writing this application hard?*



*Not enough functional programming!*

*Please ask  
questions!*

# ping

```
client(Pid) ->  
  {server, Pid} ! {ping,self()};  
  receive  
    pong ->  
      client(Pid)  
  end.
```

```
server()  
  receive  
    {ping, Pid} ->  
      Pid ! pong;  
      server()  
  end.
```

# ping

```
client(Pid) ->  
  {server, Pid} ! {ping, self()};  
  receive  
    pong ->  
      client(Pid)  
  end.
```

Can we do better than ickiness?

```
server()  
  receive  
    {ping, Pid} ->  
      Pid ! pong;  
      server()  
  end.
```

impure  
ickiness

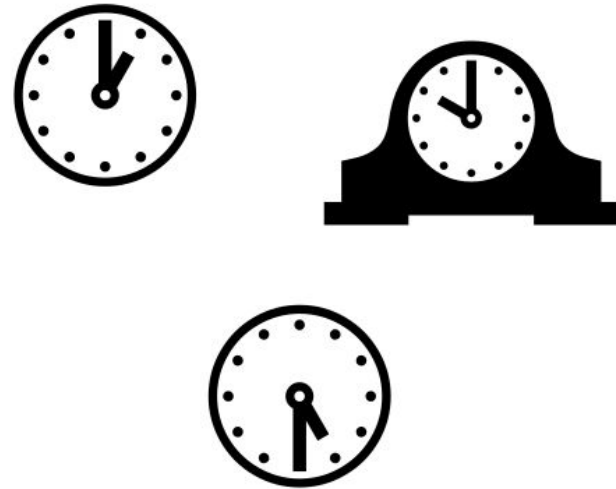
*What is a  
distributed  
program?*

*“places”*



*Space*

*“moments”*



*Time*



Spacetime  $\rightarrow a$

temperature ::  
Spacetime  $\rightarrow$  Kelvin

# *Relativistic Functional Reactive Programming*

Behavior  $a = \text{Spacetime} \rightarrow a$

Event  $a = \text{Map Spacetime } a$

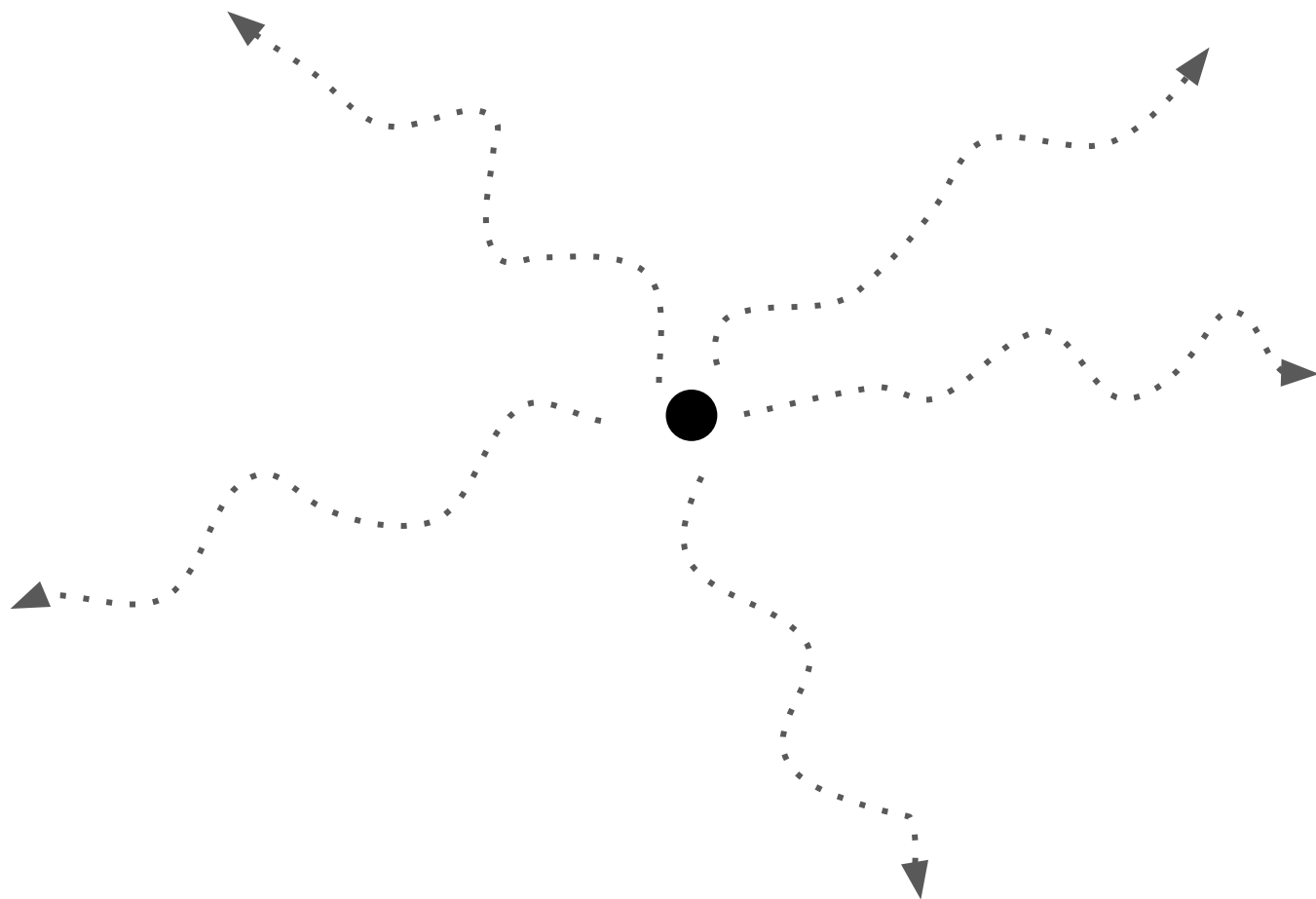
# *Relativistic Functional Reactive Programming*

Conal Elliott & Paul Hudak, 1997

Behavior  $a$  = Spacetime  $\rightarrow a$

Event  $a$  = Map Spacetime  $a$

*What about communication?*

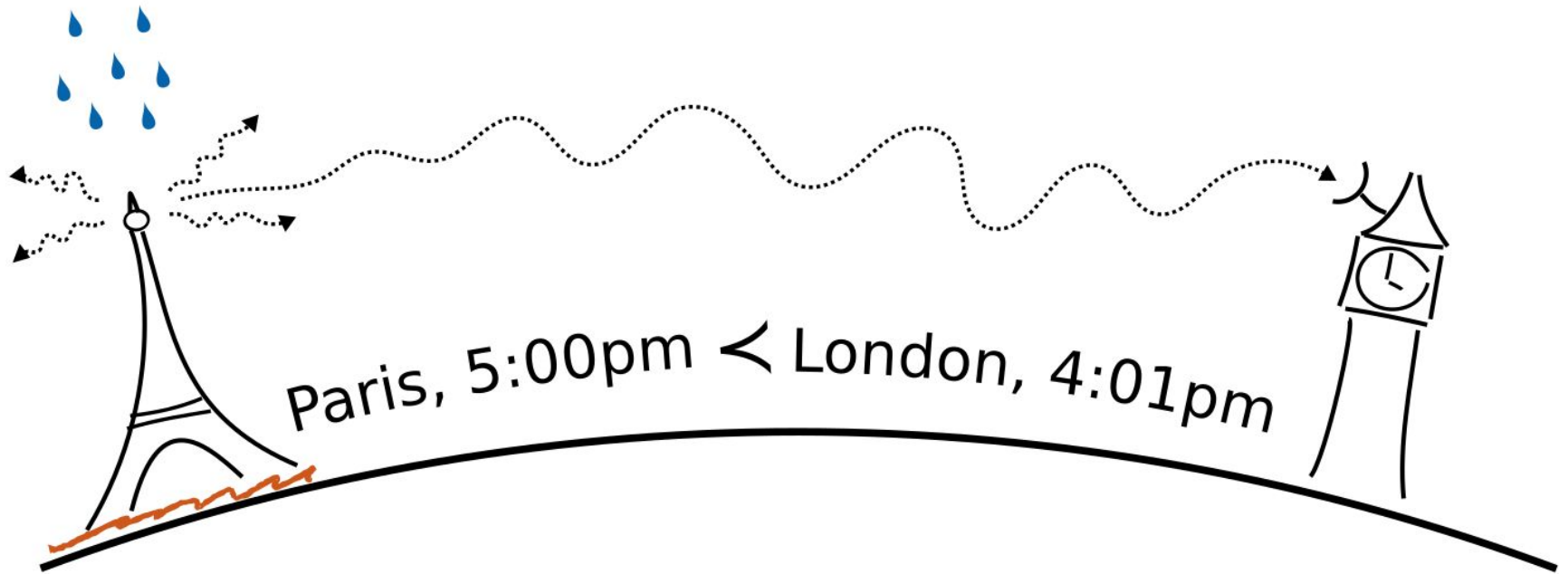




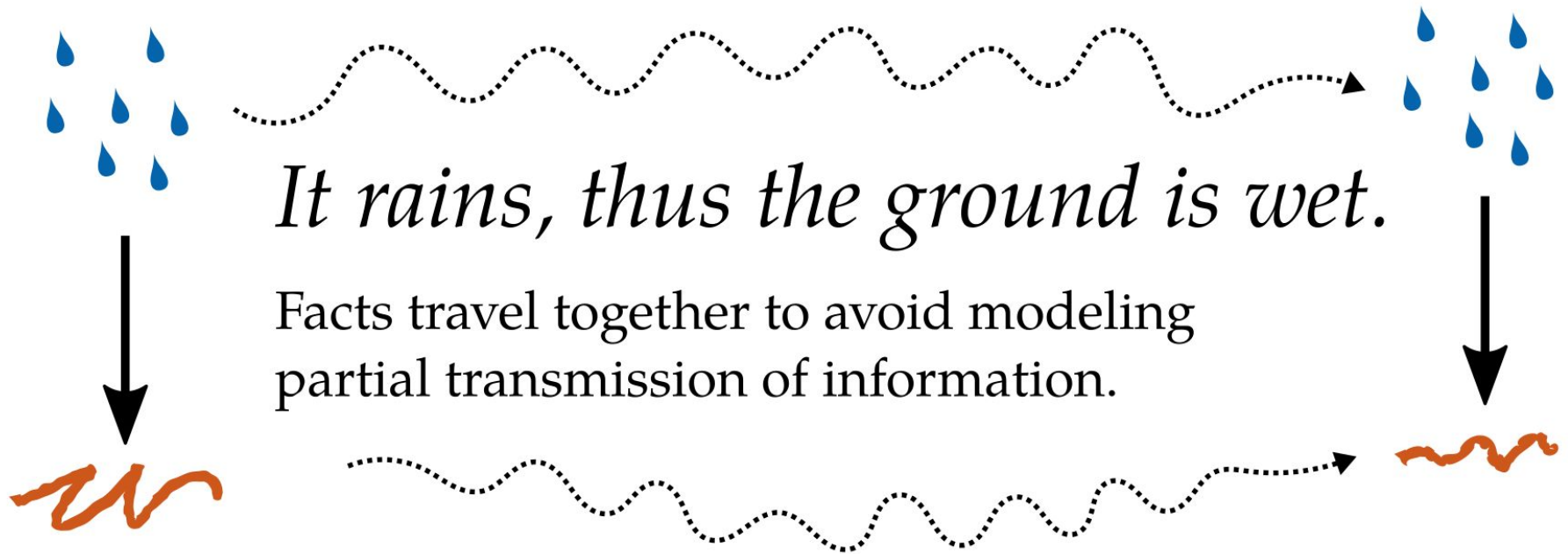


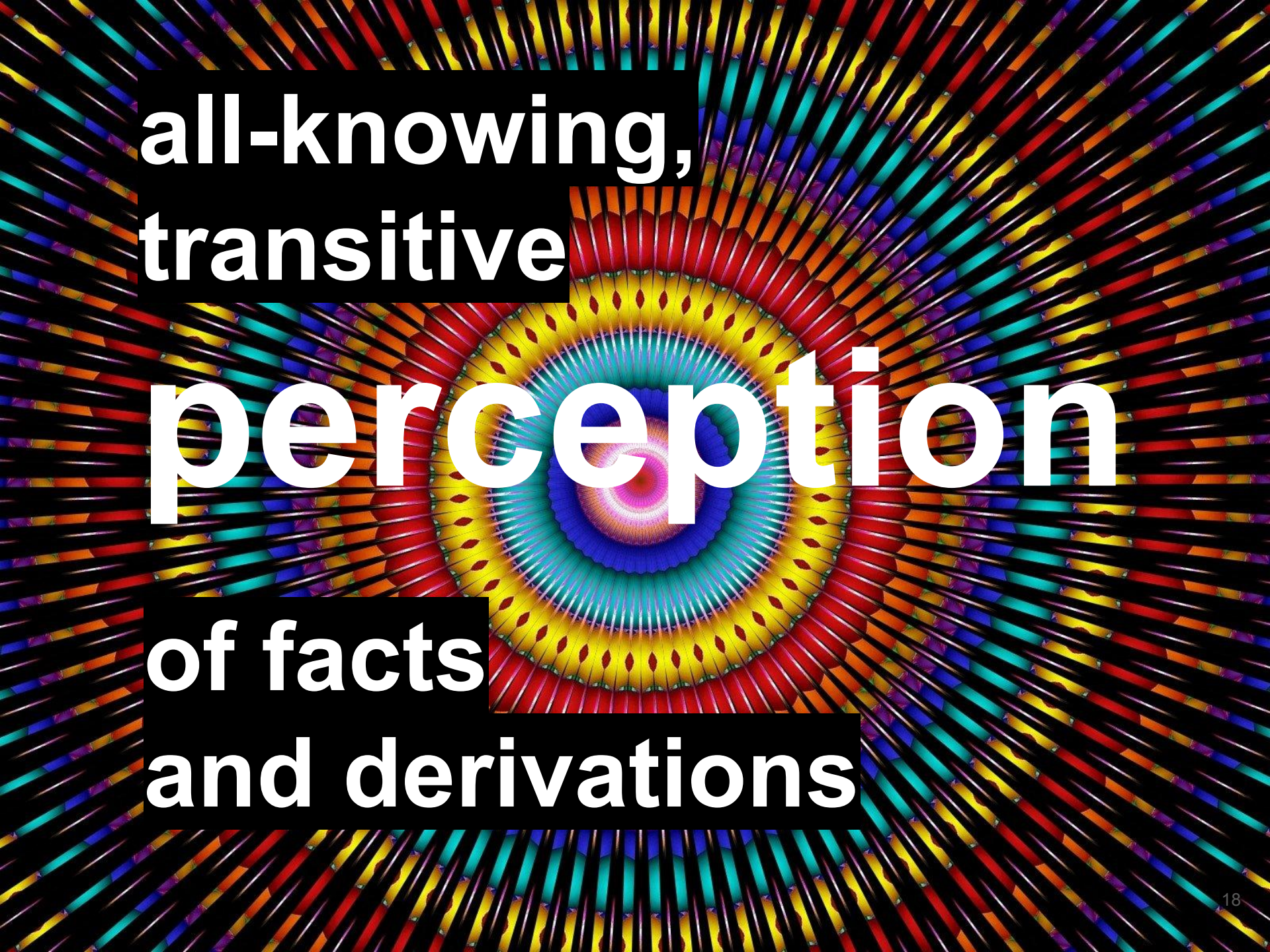
perception









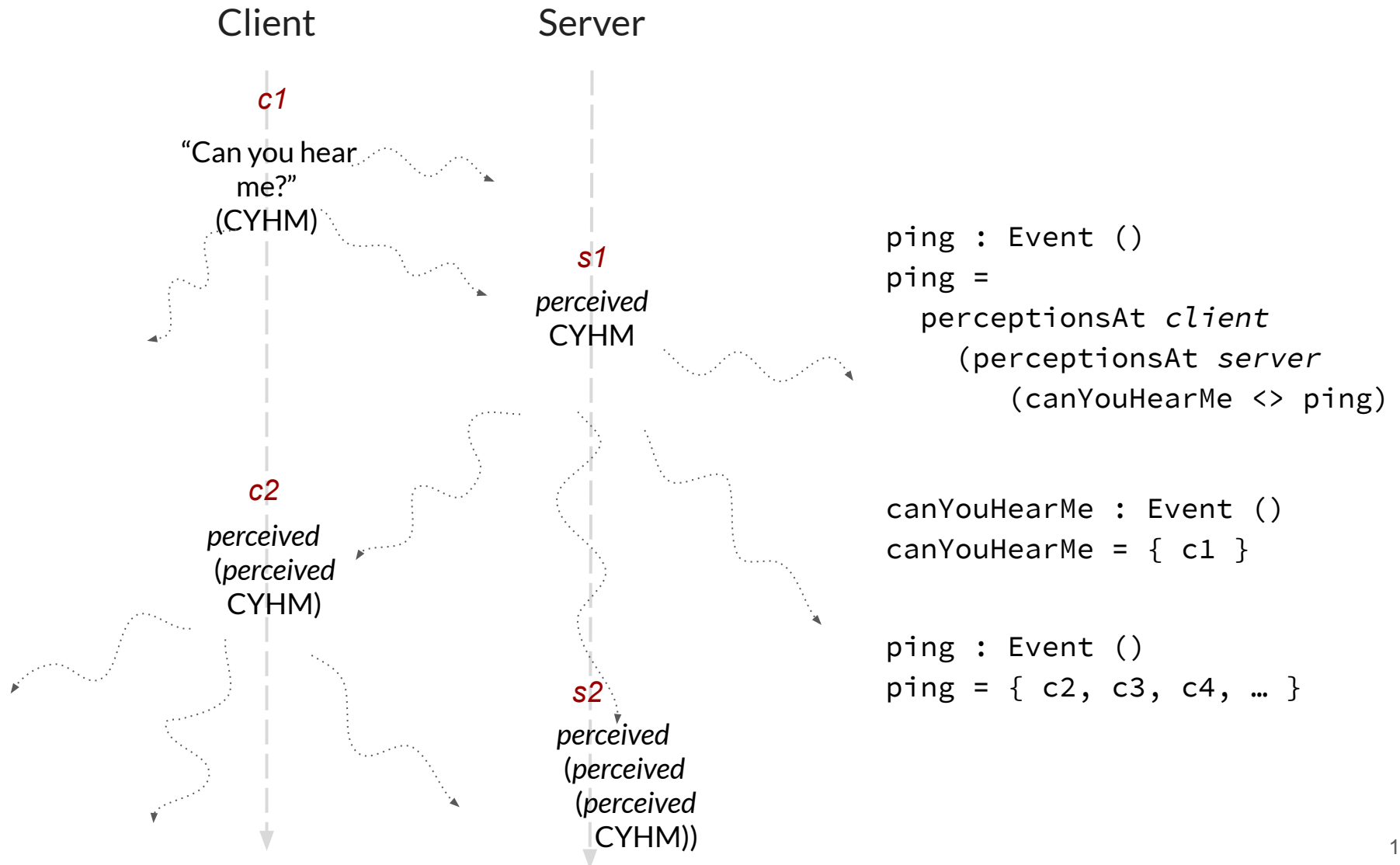


**all-knowing,  
transitive**

**perception**

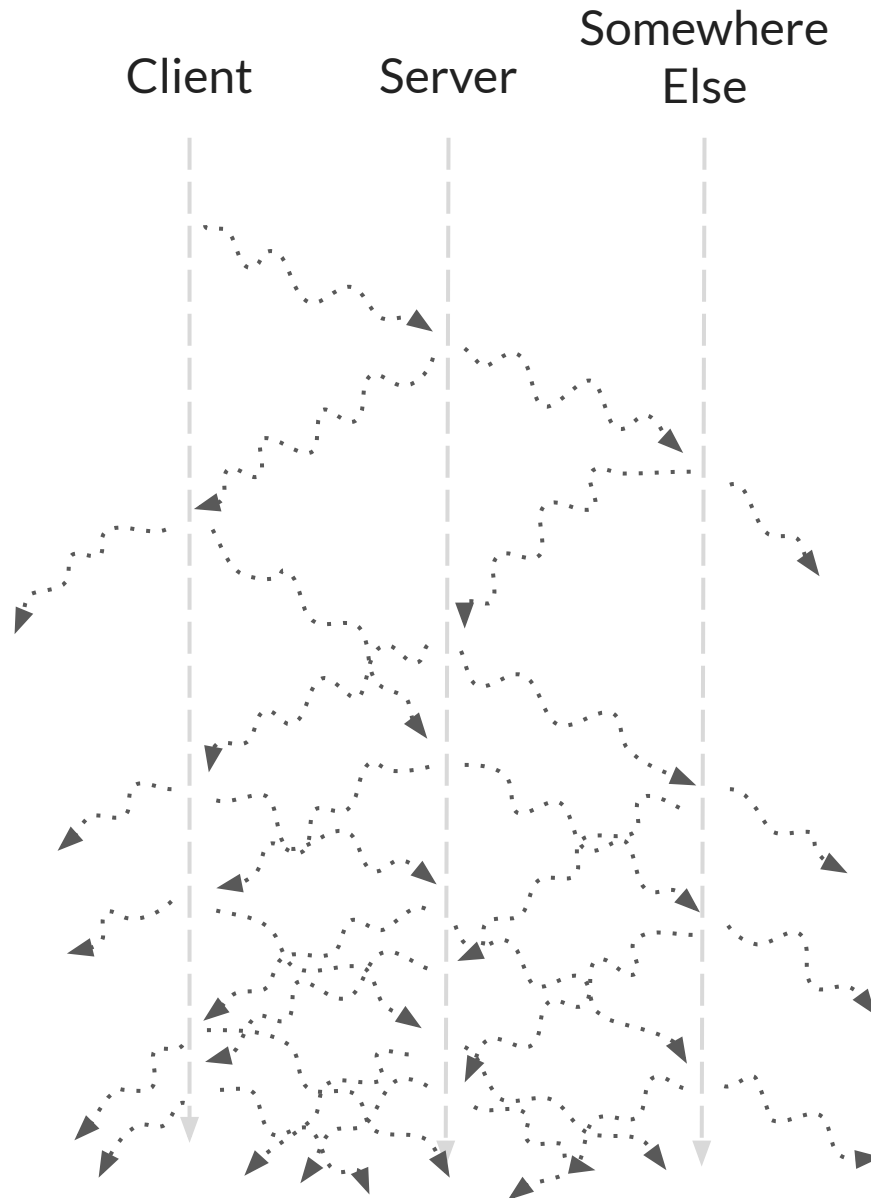
**of facts  
and derivations**

# ping through the lens of perception





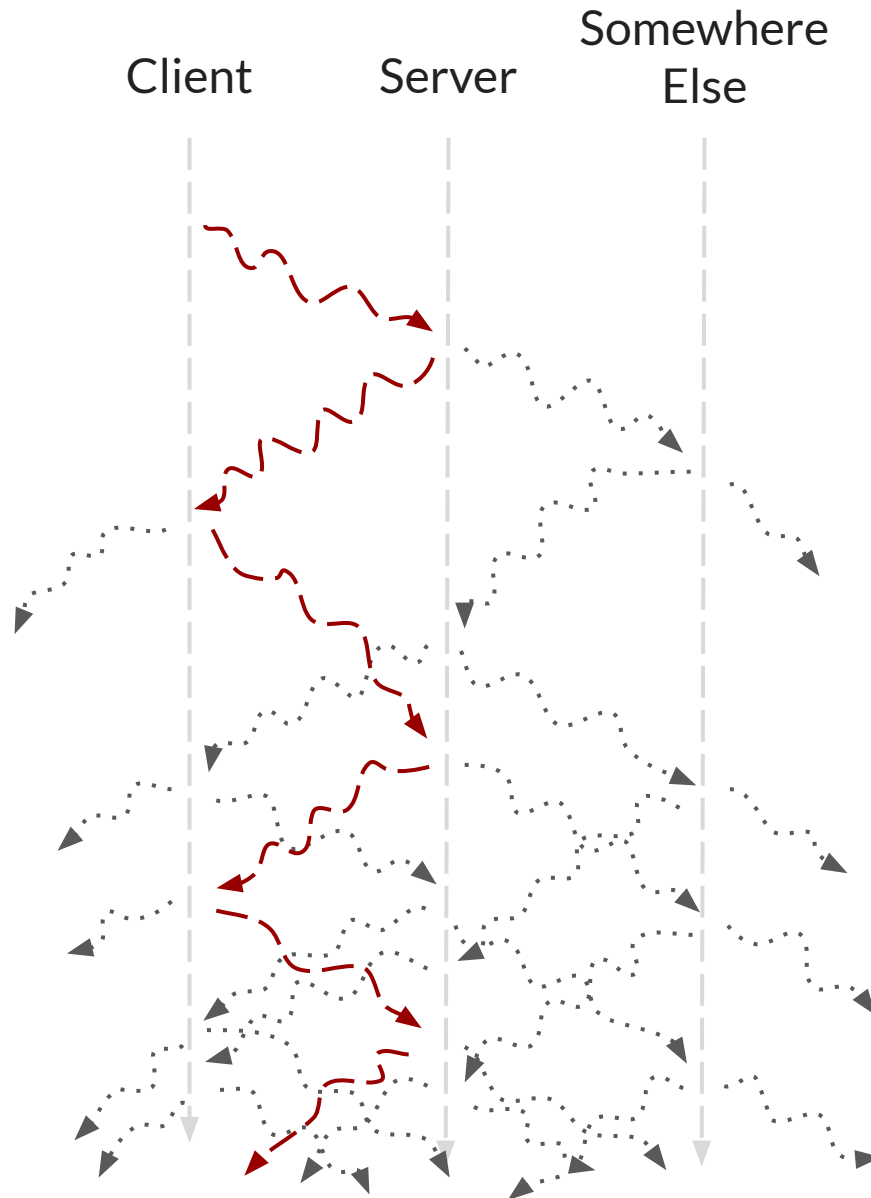
# Location-free programming



```
pingish : Event () → Event ()  
pingish start =  
  perceptions  
    (perceptions  
      (start <> pingish))
```

```
ping : Event () → Event ()  
ping start =  
  at client  
    (restrict [client, server]  
      (pingish start))
```

# Location-free programming



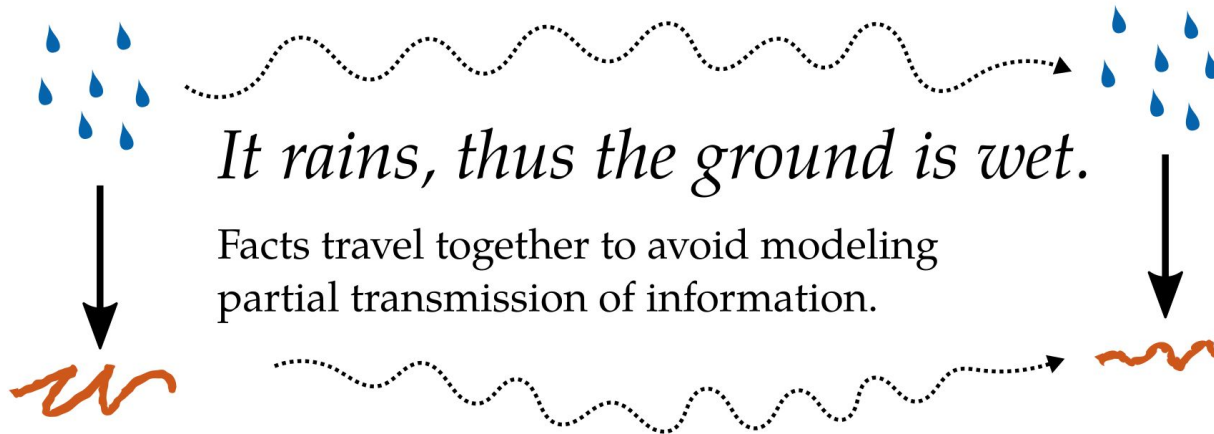
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pingish : Event () → Event ()  
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    (perceptions  
      (start <> pingish))
```

```
ping : Event () → Event ()  
ping start =  
  at client  
    (restrict [client, server]  
      (pingish start))
```

# Relativistic Functional Reactive Programming

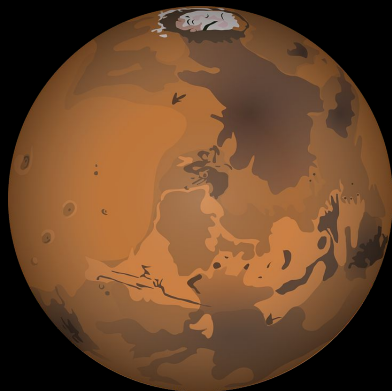
Behavior  $a = \text{Spacetime} \rightarrow a$

Event  $a = \text{Map Spacetime } a$



*Perception is transitive*

$$a < b \wedge b < c \Rightarrow a < c$$

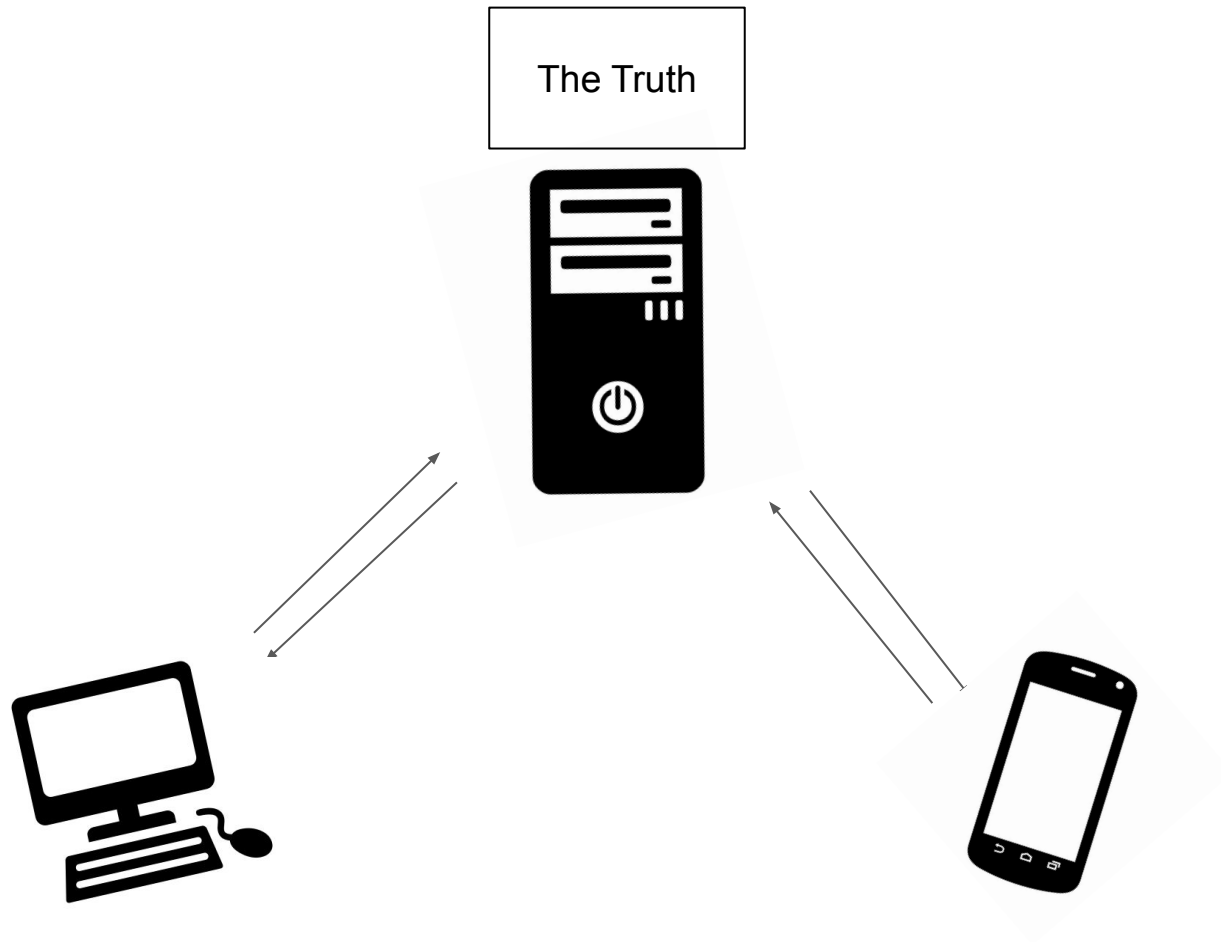


### Astro-do

|                                     |                                     |                  |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|
| ✗                                   | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Get eggs         |
| ✗                                   | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Fix solar panels |
| ✗                                   | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Send post card   |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                                     | New task         |



*4-20 minutes to  
communicate*

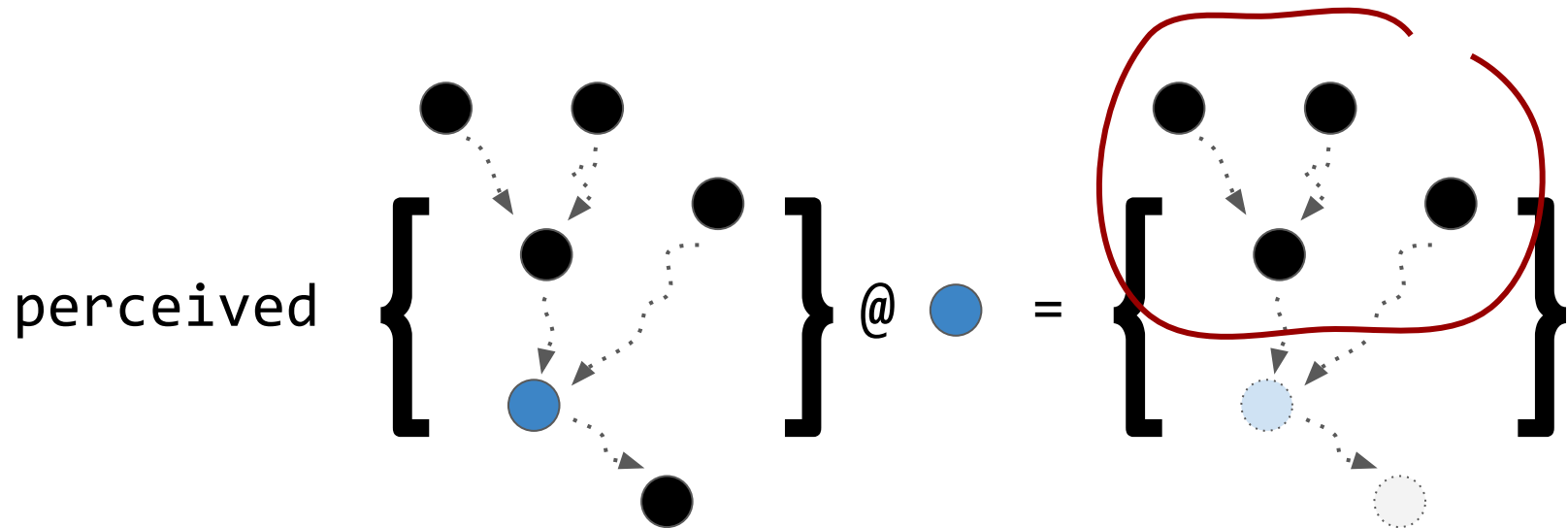




# *Strong Eventual Consistency*

*“predictably derive a result from known operations”*

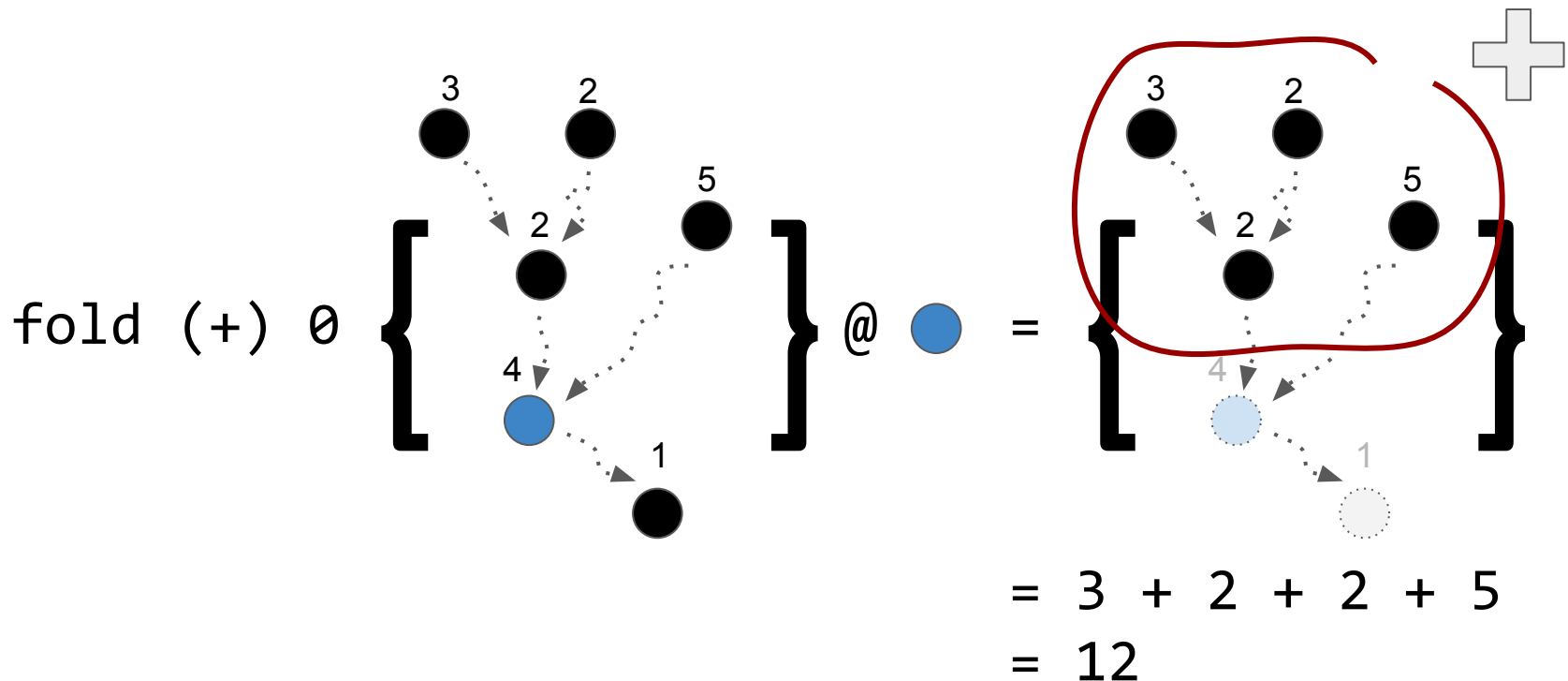
*“predictably derive a result from known operations”*



“predictably derive a result from known operations”

fold :: (a → a → a) → a → Event a → Behavior a

Commutative & associative combining function      initial value



# Astro-do

|                          |                                     |                                           |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| ✗                        | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Get eggs                                  |
| ✗                        | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Fix solar panels                          |
| ✗                        | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Send post card                            |
| <input type="checkbox"/> |                                     | <input type="button" value="+ New task"/> |

✗ ☒ Fix solar panels



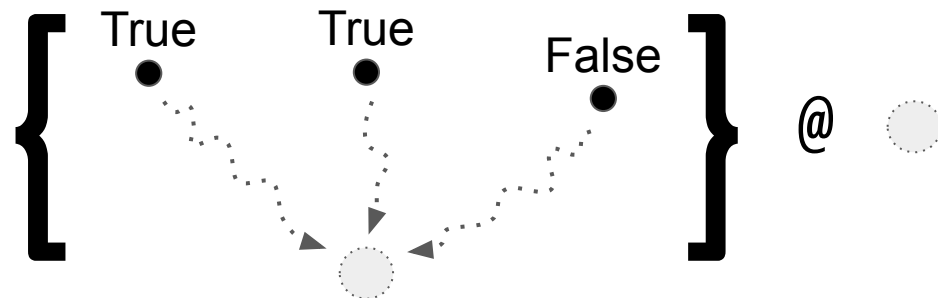
Fix solar panels

*Is “Fix solar panels” deleted?* ❌

fold (||) False { True True False } @ ●

= True || True || False

= True



# *Conflict-Free Replicated Data Types*

type Crdt operations values =  
Event operations  $\rightarrow$  Behavior values



## *Enable-Once Flag CRDT*

`eoflag :: Crdt Bool Bool`

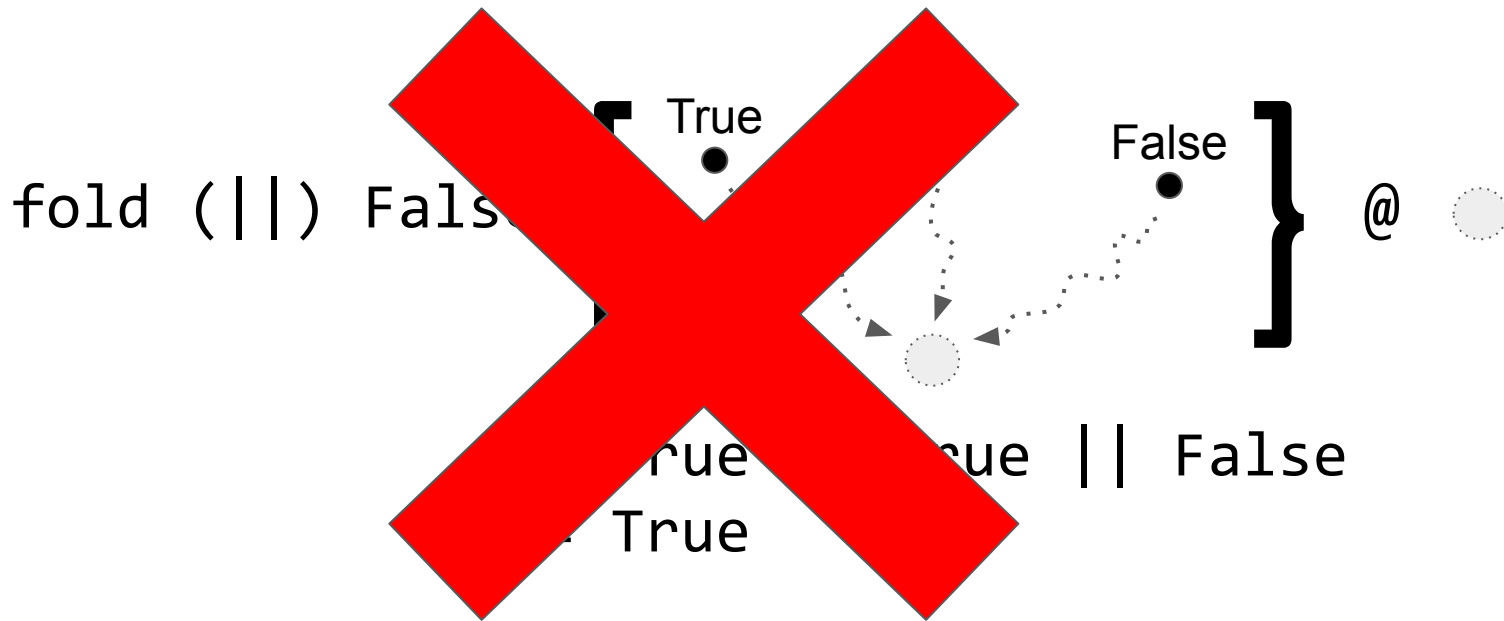
`eoflag = fold (||) False`



Fix solar panels

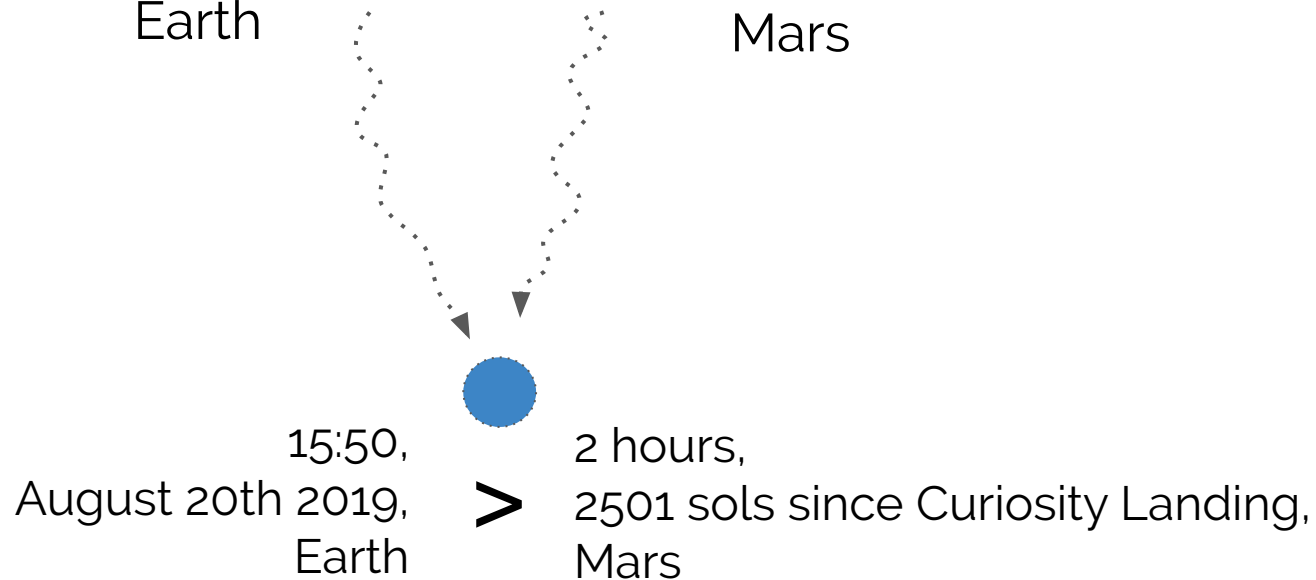


*Do the solar panels need fixing?*



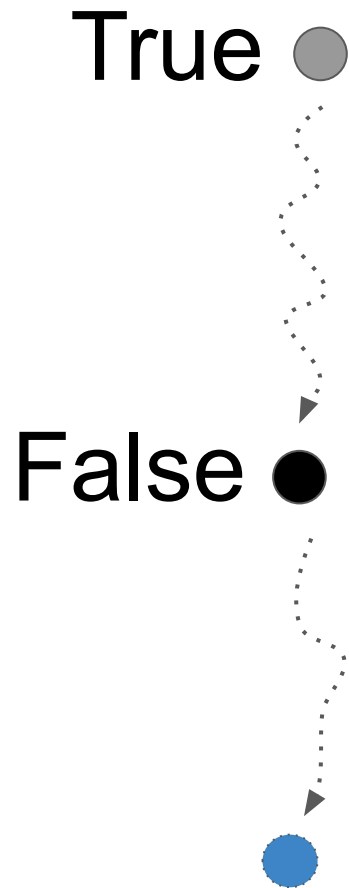
*“Overriding” decisions?*

15:50, August 20th 2019, Earth      **True**      **False**      2 hours, 2501 sols since Curiosity Landing, Mars



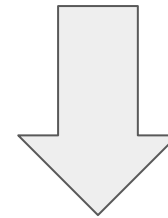
⇒ True

~~Last-Winner-Wins~~



{ ● , ● }

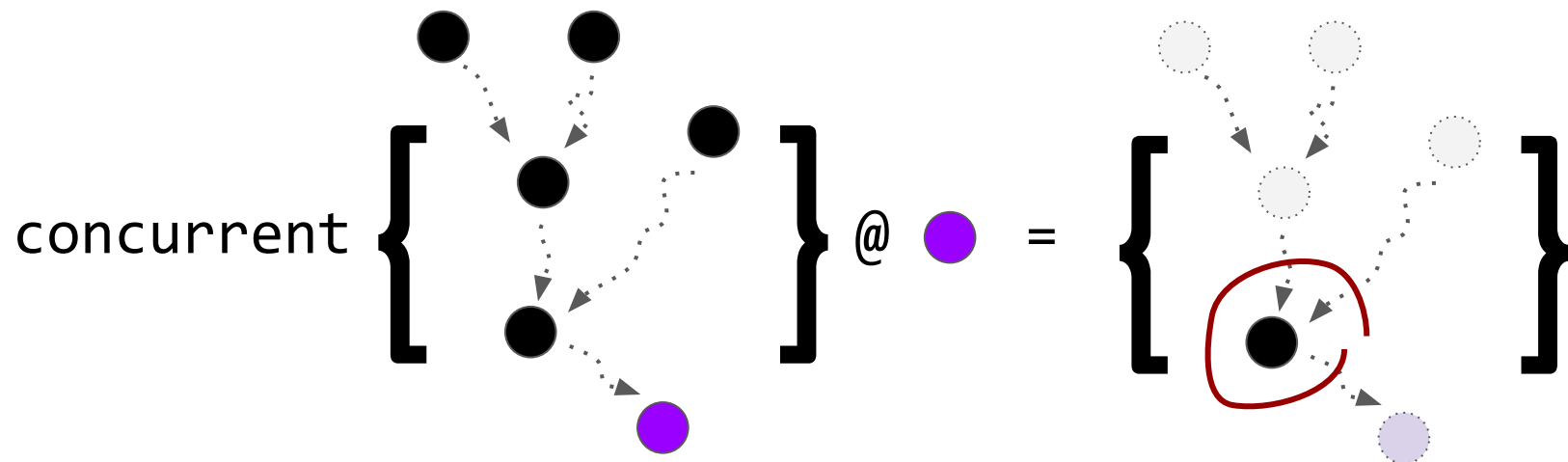
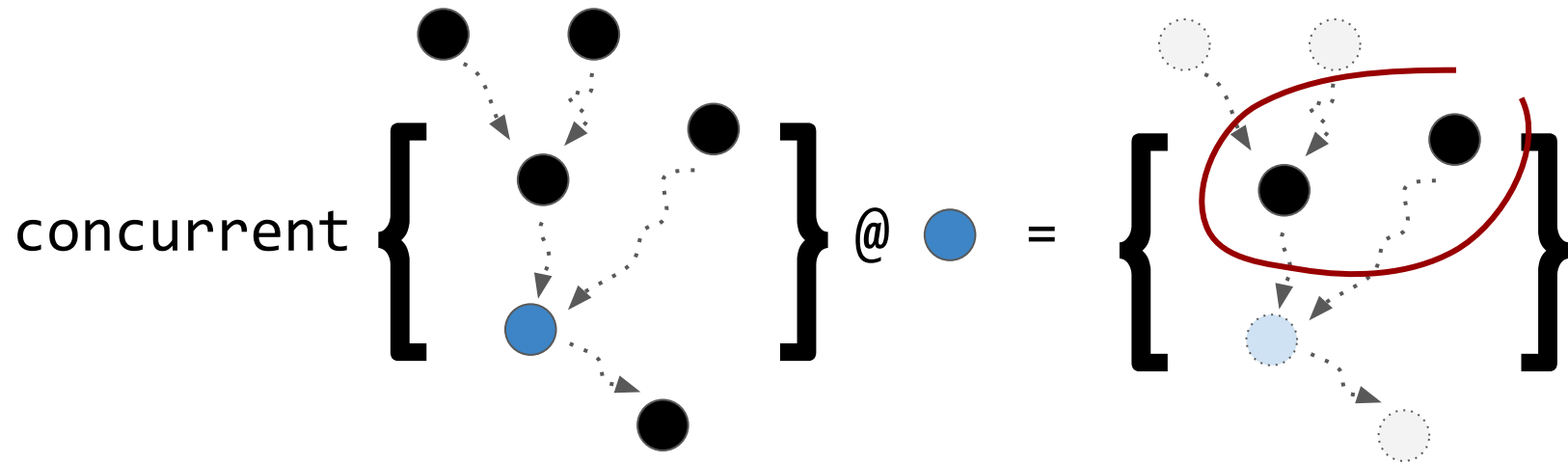
● < ●



● = False

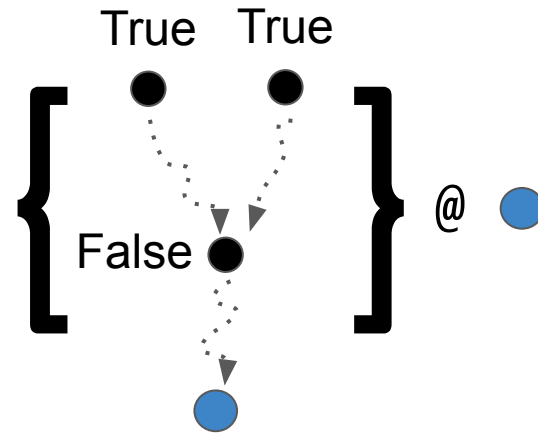
*Concurrent events*

concurrent  $:: \text{Event } a \rightarrow \text{Behavior (Event } a)$



# *Do the solar panels need fixing?*

(eoflag =<< concurrent)  
= False



$(=<<) :: \text{Behavior } a \rightarrow (a \rightarrow \text{Behavior } b) \rightarrow \text{Behavior } b$



## *Enable-Once Flag CRDT*

`eoflag :: Crdt Bool Bool`

`eoflag = fold (||) False`

## *Enable-Wins Flag CRDT*

`ewflag :: Crdt Bool Bool`

`ewflag = (eoflag =<< concurrent)`



Fix solar panels



## Fix solar panels

1. Insert 'x' @ 10

≠

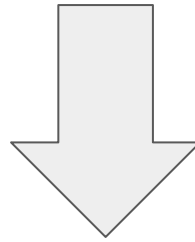
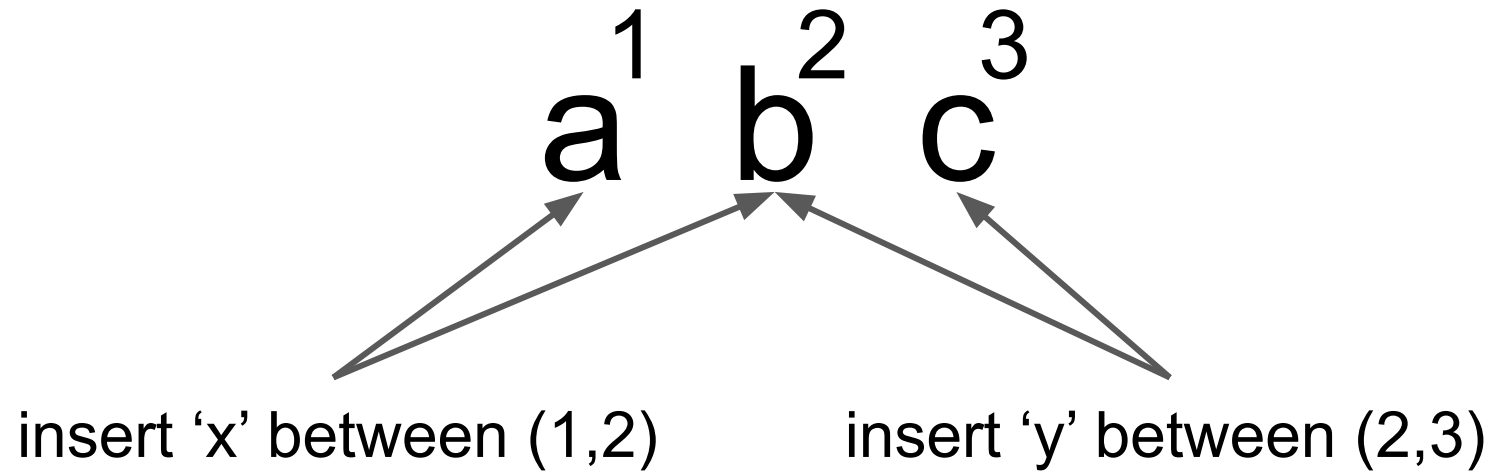
1. Insert 'y' @ 10

2. Insert 'y' @ 10

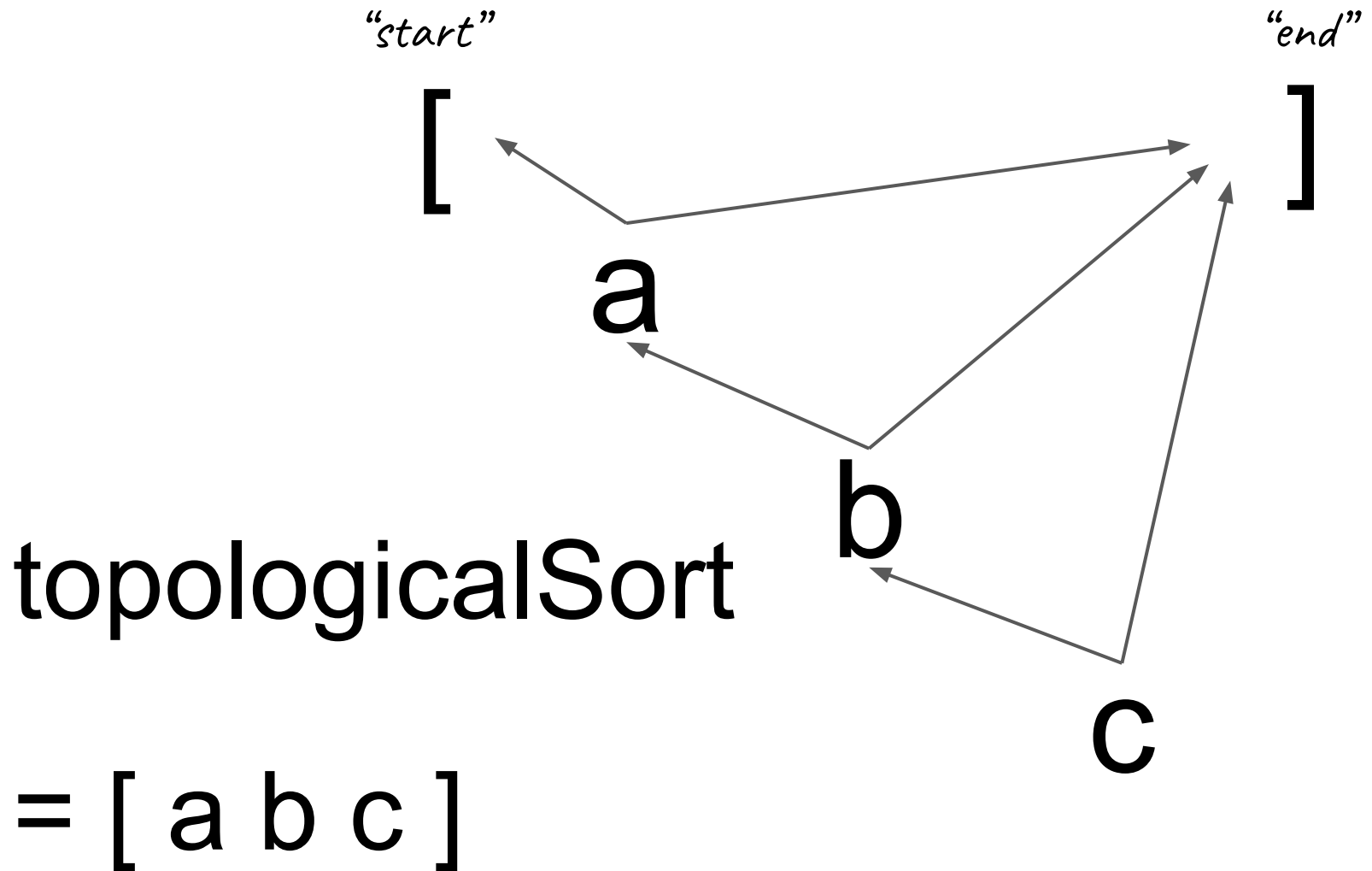
2. Insert 'x' @ 10

Fix solar xypanels

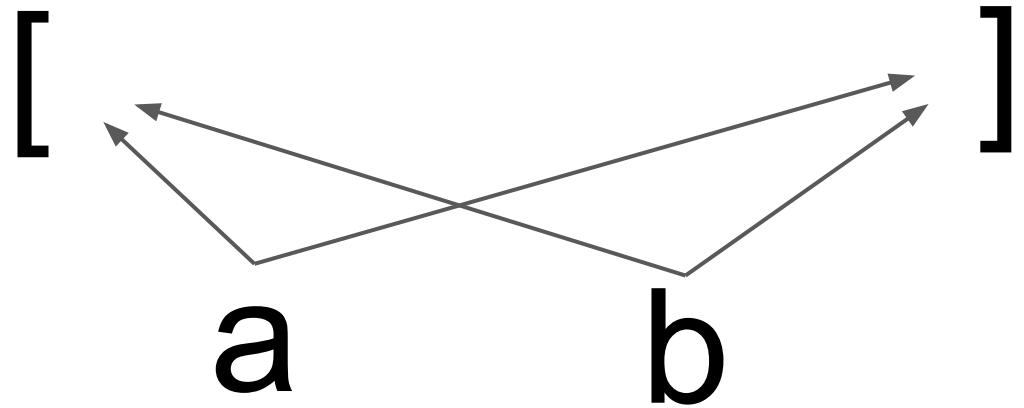
Fix solar yxpanels



$a^1$   $x^4$   $b^2$   $y^5$   $c^3$



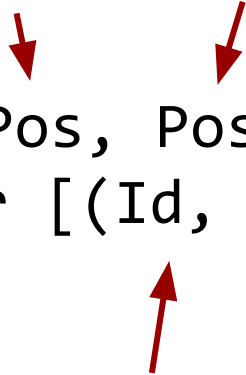
topologicalSort



[ a b ] or [ b a ] ?

*Tie breaking on identifiers*

*Let's program sequences!*



```
sequence :: Event (Pos, Pos, a)
           → Behavior [(Id, a)]
```

```
data Pos = Start
         | Middle Id
         | End
```

```
type Id = Spacetime
```

```
tagWithSpacetime :: Event a
                   → Event (Spacetime, a)
```



```
sequence :: Event (Pos, Pos, a)
          → Behavior [(Id, a)]
```

```
sequence e =
  let idsE = tagWithSpacetime e
      graphB = fold Set.union Set.empty
                (mapE Set.singleton idsE)
  in mapB topologicalSort graphB
```

```
topologicalSort :: Set (Id, (Pos, Pos, a))
                → [(Id, a)]
```

```
mapE :: (a → b) → Event a → Event b
```

```
mapB :: (a → b) → Behavior a → Behavior b
```

# Sequence with deletion

sequence :: Event (Pos, Pos, a)  
→ Behavior [(Id, a)]

$a = \text{Behavior} (\text{Bool}, a')$



Behavior [(Id, Behavior Bool a)]

filter + (= <<) ~ Behavior [(Id, a)]

enable-once  
flag

### Astro-do

✗

☒

Get eggs

✗

☒

Fix solar panels

✗

☐

Send post card

+

New task

✗

☒

Fix solar panels

enable-wins  
flag

sequence +  
enable-once flag

# WIP

## Eventually Consistent

## RFRP

- Library UX for GUI
- Extending Reflex!  
<https://github.com/reflex-frp/reflex>  
=> Production quality P2P apps
- Hard problems (PhD)

# Sequence with deletion

sequence :: Event (Pos, Pos, a)  
→ Behavior [(Id, a)]

$a = \text{Behavior} (\text{Bool}, a')$



Behavior [(Id, Behavior Bool a)]

filter + (= <<) ~ Behavior [(Id, a)]

# Relativistic Functional Reactive Programming

Behavior  $a = \text{Spacetime} \rightarrow a$

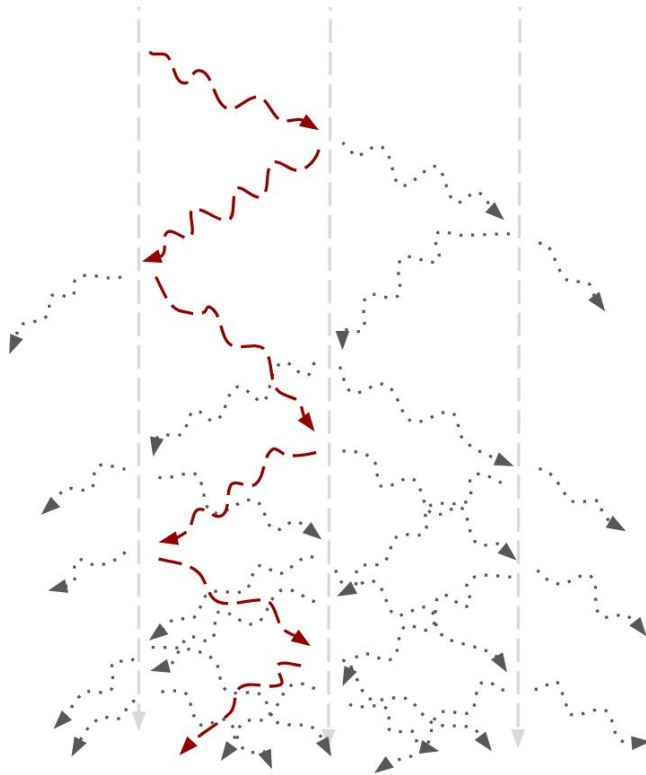
Event  $a = \text{Map Spacetime } a$



@aidylns



@parenthetical



`fold :: (a → a → a) (Commutative & associative)`  
→ `a`  
→ `Event a`  
→ `Behavior a`

`concurrent :: Event a`  
→ `Behavior (Event a)`

*Peer-to-peer apps for free!*

*Probabilistic*

*Relativistic*

*Functional Reactive Programming*

Behavior  $a \rightarrow (\text{Spacetime}, \text{Probability}, a)$

temperature  $:: \text{Spacetime} \rightarrow \text{Kelvin}$

# Astro-do

✗

☒

Get eggs

✗

☒

Fix solar panels

✗

☐

Send post card

☐

+

New task

✗

☒

Get eggs

✗

☒

Fix solar panels